VILLAGER STEERING GEAR RETAINER BOLT TORQUE CHECK

AFFECTED VEHICLES: ALL 1999 AND CERTAIN 2000 MODEL YEAR VILLAGER

OVERVIEW

This procedure will provide the details to **1)** inspect the five (5) steering gear retainer bolts to see if they are loose (indicated by the bolt turning before the torque wrench reaches the desired torque setting), **2)** inspect the steering gear housing mounting brackets for damage if any bolts are found loose, and **3)** replace the bracket(s) as necessary if damage is found.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

1. Raise and support the vehicle on a hoist.
2. Check the torque on each of the five (5) steering gear retainer bolts. The torque specification is 84 Nm (62 lb-ft). See Figure 1.

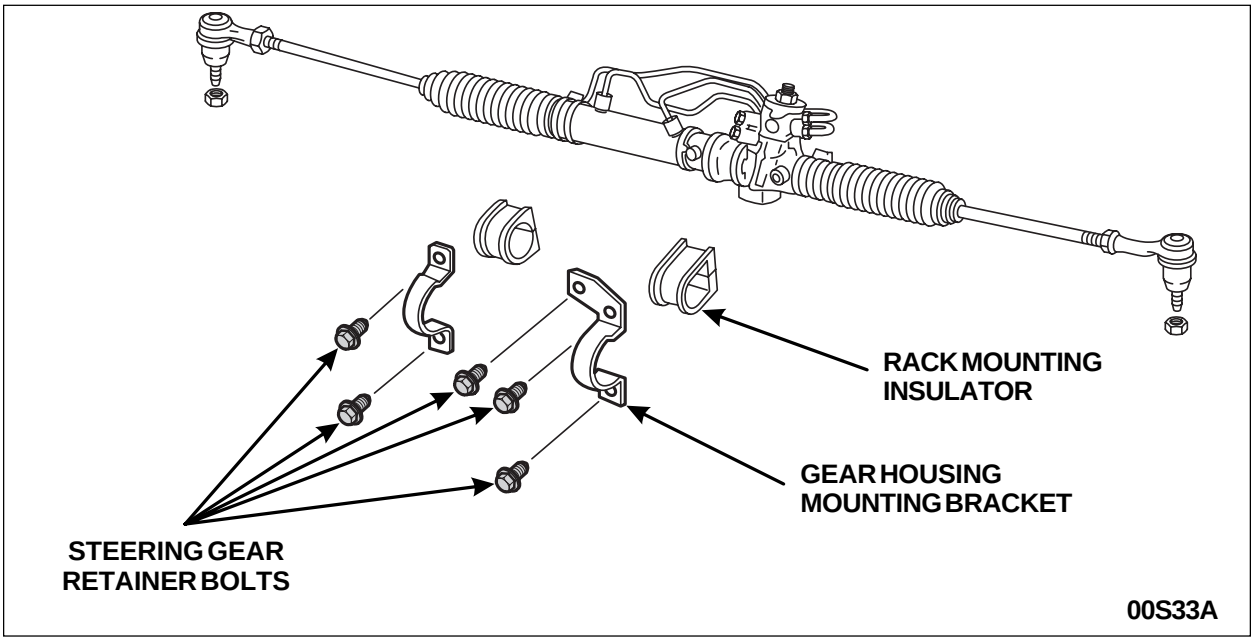

FIGURE 1

3. If none of the bolts were loose, no service is required. Lower and release the vehicle.
4. If any bolt is found loose or missing, remove that bolt and inspect the hole in the bracket for signs of damage (hole elongated, paint worn from inside of bolt hole indicating movement of the bracket, etc.). Please note that the right side bracket is manufactured with the upper hole slightly elongated vertically as an aid to assembly. Do not mistake this for damage.
5. If no bracket damage is found, reinstall the bolts. Replace any missing bolts. Tighten the bolts to 84 Nm (62 lb-ft). Then lower and release the vehicle.
6. If either bracket is found damaged, that bracket must be replaced. **DO NOT REMOVE BOTH BRACKETS FROM THE STEERING GEAR AT THE SAME TIME.** Replace each bracket separately with a ***new*** bracket. Replace any bolt that is damaged at the same time.
7. Lower and release the vehicle.

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